

County Executive (11)
Office Of Economic Development (11_0710)

Account Class	Account Rollup Name	Expended 2023	Adopted 2024	Appropriated 2024	Projected 2024	Requested 2025	Allowed 2025
100 Annual Regular Salaries	1010 Net-Annual Regular	571,207	566,209	566,209	566,209	602,172	602,172
		571,207	566,209	566,209	566,209	602,172	602,172
101 Other Personal Services	1200 Hourly	156,333	146,250	146,250	146,250	153,000	153,000
		156,333	146,250	146,250	146,250	153,000	153,000
300 Material & Supplies	3600 Printing & Office Suppl	11,657	8,000	8,610	8,000	8,000	8,000
	3700 Postage Costs	952	1,000	1,000	1,000	1,000	1,000
		12,609	9,000	9,610	9,000	9,000	9,000
400 Expenses	4070 Equip Service & Rental	84	3,100	3,100	1,000	1,000	1,000
	4100 Membership Fees	25,650	70,000	56,401	22,500	26,000	26,000
	4110 Travel and Meals	12,243	8,000	11,314	8,000	8,000	8,000
	4140 Communications	1,416	2,000	2,000	1,200	1,200	1,200
	4250 Public & Legal Notices	97,888	110,000	110,000	110,000	110,000	110,000
	4380 Contractual Services	3,412,392	4,121,230	3,949,281	2,600,000	1,701,585	1,701,585
	5125 Community Services	6,640,623	1,966,653	2,138,653	2,090,653	0	0
		10,190,295	6,280,983	6,270,749	4,833,353	1,847,785	1,847,785
599 Inter-Departmental Charge	5205 Information Support Svc	2,148	6,632	6,632	6,632	4,055	4,055
		2,148	6,632	6,632	6,632	4,055	4,055
Total Expenditures		10,932,592	7,009,074	6,999,450	5,561,444	2,616,012	2,616,012
Net Expenditures		10,932,592	7,009,074	6,999,450	5,561,444	2,616,012	2,616,012
50 Departmental Income		487,165	490,619	490,619	490,619	489,082	489,082
61 Agency & Trust Revenue		6,640,623	2,666,653	2,666,653	2,138,653	0	0
97 State Aid		0	0	0	0	199,397	199,397
Total Revenues		7,127,788	3,157,272	3,157,272	2,629,272	688,479	688,479
Net Department Total		3,804,805	3,851,802	3,842,178	2,932,172	1,927,533	1,927,533

Westchester County

County Executive (11)

Office Of Tourism (11_0720)

Mission Statement

Westchester County Tourism, the County's official tourism marketing organization, is dedicated to building Westchester County's economy and positive image through tourism marketing for growth in business and leisure, meetings, group tour and convention development, major events and promoting the County on a regional, national and international basis.

To accomplish this mission, Westchester County Tourism is responsible for the destination marketing and promotion of hotel rooms and convention attendance within the County; working with tourist- related organizations within the County to coordinate advertising, promotion and programming; working with state and regional organizations that are responsible for the promotion of the Hudson River Valley; and finally, coordinating activities within County government which directly or indirectly impact tourism. Westchester County Tourism is funded through the 3% Westchester County Room Occupancy Tax. In accordance with the Westchester County Room Occupancy Tax law, 15% of the 3% revenue is allocated to Tourism and represents the annual tourism budget. For Film, we encourage and promote film and media productions, facilitate location scout inquiries, permit County-owned properties and provide assistance and support/solutions to production companies and municipalities. Partner with state and regional film organizations to further advance the County as a location.

	2024	2025
POSITIONS		
Operating	5	5
Grants		
	5	5
OPERATING BUDGET EXPENDITURES		
Personal Services	591,331	604,135
Equipment		
Material & Supplies	7,500	6,800
Expenses	2,920,612	1,936,298
Interdepartmental Charges	4,536	5,701
TOTAL EXPENDITURES	3,523,979	2,552,934
OPERATING BUDGET REVENUES		
Interdepartmental		
Departmental	954,580	1,377,264
State and Federal Aid	2,124,923	1,175,670
TOTAL REVENUES	3,079,503	2,552,934
DEPARTMENT TAX LEVY	444,476	0

County Executive (11)
Office Of Tourism (11_0720)

	<u>2024</u>	<u>2025</u>
Estimated Share of Miscellaneous Budget Items:		
Retirement Systems	112,016	121,471
Health Insurance and Benefits	176,253	183,165
DEPARTMENT TOTAL	732,745	304,636

The Appropriated 2024 figures in the supporting detail include all budget amendments through August 31, 2024 and Appropriations Assigned for Purchases on Order ("roll forwards") of \$5,214.

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Office Of Tourism (11_0720)

PROGRAM AREA AND SERVICES:

GENERAL GOVERNMENT SUPPORT

- ✓ Promote Westchester County for business and leisure travel, generating \$2.2 billion into the County's economy.
- ✓ Promote Westchester County for film and TV productions, permitting County-owned properties, providing assistance and support to location scouts and municipalities, helping to generate economic activity of more than \$2 billion in Westchester in 2022-2023.
- ✓ Attend trade shows on behalf of hotel and attraction partners to gain leads for new business; host familiarization trips for meeting planners, group tour operators and travel writers.
- ✓ Market and advertise Westchester County through traditional and digital media in association with I Love NY branding.
- ✓ Enhance Westchester County's visibility through Hudson Valley Tourism and other regional tourism organizations.
- ✓ Assist in developing the area's travel and tourism industry by providing research, creating marketing partnerships and synergy between hotel properties and attractions by providing a forum and acting as a catalyst to stimulate tourism product development.

DEPARTMENT INITIATIVES:

NEW

- ✓ New account-based marketing (ABM) deploying unique audience insights to target professional meeting and events planners for awareness building and lead generation showcasing the expanded Westchester Workshops that offers curated experiences to groups booking 50+ hotel rooms by July 1, 2025. These campaigns will be served programmatically across consumable digital media channels and via an enhanced LinkedIn campaign to increase RFP submissions, and drive acquisition for the meeting and event planner newsletter.

- ✓ Stimulate new and repeat leisure visitation by creating niche segment tourism videos with tailored content about the County's Craft Beverage, African American Heritage Trail, Revolutionary/History Trail to commemorate the 250th, and Farm Trail Sites, driving targeted traffic and enhancing the visibility of Westchester as a unique and culturally rich destination for distribution primarily through social media channels; increase community, followers and engagement to Westchester Tourism & Film social media accounts on Facebook, Twitter/X, YouTube, Instagram and Flickr.
- ✓ As consumers increasingly engage with content across multiple platforms, piloting a tourism campaign via Connected TV (CTV) to significantly raise awareness and engagement for our County's tourism offerings. This campaign will feature three segments with QR codes highlighting the destination's top-performing attributes for foodies, nature loving enthusiasts and family's things to do. By leveraging ad-supported streaming platforms, we aim to positively influence hotel bookings and drive tourism growth.
- ✓ Based on the EDA Tourism Recovery and Resiliency findings, new photo and video capture to enhance Tourism's integrated marketing efforts and increase our usable image library to better reflect the County's competitive strengths, featuring diversity and accessibility.
- ✓ In response to the EDA Tourism Recovery and Resiliency findings, Tourism expand Influencer campaign to prioritize social media creators and journalists with niche focus to build trust with targeted audiences through authentic, relatable content, boosting credibility and interest. It also generates real-time engagement and visibility.
- ✓ Reimagine and update the Westchester signature agritourism Bounty to promote agricultural heritage, encourage farm visits, including the NYS designated Farm Trail, featured authentic and rural experiences, local produce tasting and support of local farmers. Creating a new aesthetic branded brochure and digital activation to boost Westchester's appeal as a unique destination.

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- ✓ After conducting research, best practices and discussion with experts, optimize and refine the Westchester accessible tourism plan. The enhanced plan includes a robust schedule of B2B workshops promoting best practices, the creation of an accessible tourism toolkit, ongoing surveying of accessible features at destinations and continued development of accessible tourism itineraries to increase consideration and intent to travel.
- ✓ Engage a nationally known economic development firm to measure the economic impact in 2024 of the film sector in Westchester County across various business sectors and local partners.
- ✓ Enhance content marketing approach to showcase Westchester's thriving film ecosystem, including its prime locations, resources and support network of businesses and organizations. Explore expanding this outreach through the launch of an industry-focused newsletter on LinkedIn, while growing the contact list for broader engagement.
- ✓ Collaborate to cultivate future workforce by convening a meeting of the County's higher education institutions, secondary and vocational schools, certificate programs and community stakeholders to discuss their film-related pro-grams. Share best practices and how best to support this growing sector with a pool of skilled talent.
- ✓ Broaden digital marketing efforts with fresh, high-quality content across platforms like Instagram, where location scouts are particularly active to increase brand awareness, drive website traffic, and attract more potential clients.
- ✓ Enhance promotion of Westchester County as a top-tier destination for film production with a robust communications program including media relations, interviews and testimonials with film professionals, and information and resources from local and state partners, distributed via blogs, social media, and quarterly newsletter.
- ✓ Update, produce and distribute official visitor publications, including the Westchester Official Meeting & Travel Guide and other niche brochures.
- ✓ Manage tradeshow program with hotel and attraction partners and the New York State DMO consortium, partnering to leverage resources and increase reach.
- ✓ Increase consumer/business data acquisition for leads, newsletters and social media channels.
- ✓ Participate in Hudson Valley Tourism (travelhudsonvalley.com), NYS Haunted Trail, Wine, Water and Wonder and I Love NY programs to build Westchester County Tourism visibility and branding.
- ✓ Participate in Hudson Valley Tourism (travelhudsonvalley.com) and I Love NY programs to build Westchester County Tourism visibility and branding.
- ✓ Maintain and expand the visitwestchesterny.com website in partnership with Simpleview and I Love NY.
- ✓ Serve as a content provider with the re-branded MNR/LIR getaways and itineraries to align under the new MTA Away umbrella platform.

ON-GOING

- ✓ Aggressively grow interest in Westchester County as a leisure traveler getaway through the Beyond brand and more impactful promotional tactics continuing focused multi-tiered integrated marketing campaign in a 90 mile radius showcasing Westchester County as a short getaway escape and premier regional destination.
- ✓ Generate awareness and visibility regarding Westchester County at targeted meetings and corporate, consumer, and group tour tradeshow to increase awareness and conversion. Support with advertising that drives responses to a landing page that complements the messaging and asks for an online RFP.

DEPARTMENT ACCOMPLISHMENTS:

NEW

- ✓ Westchester County Tourism & Film's influencer campaign named as Finalist in the Ragan/PRDaily Social Media and Digital Awards.

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- ✓ Completed and finalized the EDA Tourism Recovery and Resiliency research project and reported the findings at a Tourism Partner Forum: Guiding the Future of Tourism at the Tarrytown House and Conference Center. Hunden Strategic Partners toured, surveyed, and interviewed over 70 individuals and organizations, including the Westchester Hotel Association, the Business Council of Westchester, the Westchester County Association, our legislators, our cultural Institutions, transportation and other. In addition, a visitor sentiment survey was conducted to understand what motivates visitation to Westchester County. The survey resulted in 3,000 responses on what differentiates the county from competing counties and what product gaps may be barriers to visitor selection. The grant was funded by the U.S. Department of Commerce.
- ✓ The Westchester Craft Beverage Trail is thriving with 25 participating small businesses (12 breweries, nine tap houses, two cideries and two distilleries) embodying Westchester's rich agricultural heritage and the forward-thinking ingenuity of its local artisans. Since the introduction of the Westchester Craft Beverage Trail, people have registered for the web-based passport with check-ins representing each location on the trail. Locations along the trail offer incentives to drive new and repeat business and deals redeemed. A video produced about the Trail in collaboration with New York's Best Experiences garnered 22,000 views on Facebook. Continuing engagement in conjunction with tourism partners to entice new registrations is taking place through festival participation both locally (Captain Lawrence Fall Fun Beer Fest) and nationally (The Great American Beer Festival).
- ✓ History and heritage tourism is a strong motivator for Westchester County visitors. Westchester County Tourism & Film introduced Splendor, a newly designed guide to Westchester's historic homes and gardens, which includes inspiring itineraries that capture Westchester's beauty and rich history-featuring 17 homes and gardens as well as a map and coordinating itinerary by region as well as historic locations spotted in recent film productions. The guide was inserted into Edible magazines in Manhattan, Brooklyn, and Philadelphia full circulation. Splendor was unveiled at a launch event in Manhattan with writers, influencers, and lifestyle contacts in June. It was also featured on the Edible email national newsletter list and cross-promoted on social channels.
- ✓ Included accessible features information to the Visitwestchesterny.com CRM for attractions, dining and accommodations to enhance the user experience on the website. The information was gathered through the creation of a digital survey sent to 536 tourism partners. Surveying and information gathering was completed in collaboration with I Love New York, Westchester County Office for People with Disabilities, the Westchester Advisory Council on People with Disabilities, Westchester Council of the Blind of New York, and Inclusive Initiative.
- ✓ Hosted familiarization press trips with travel and lifestyle writers to promote openings and the seasonal tourism activities of the County. Secured major media placements resulting in 38,11,742,138 impressions, highlights include- Nationalgeographic.com, Where to travel in October; Forbes, Check Out These 6 Halloween Travel Destinations In The U.S.; Thrillist, Apple Picking Farms and Orchards Near NYC; Housebeautiful.com, 40 Best Places to Visit in the Fall for Peak Foliage; Explore.com, The 12 Most Iconic Halloween Events All Across America In 2024; Timeout.com, 12 new NYC restaurants have been added to the Michelin Guide; Forbes.com, In New York, Track Spring Flowers In Bloom Through A Weekly Report; Time Out, Stunning castles in American; The Point Guy, World's Best Halloween Festivals Haunted Houses; Reader's Digest, Last Minute Vacations for Summer; Gothamist, 9 Great Places to Go Leaf Pepping if You Don't Have a Car; USA Today, Easy Weekend Getaways from NYC; Elledecor.com. 9 Last-Minute Weekend Getaways from NYC; and more.
- ✓ Planned and facilitated international tour operator and travel writer familiarization trips in collaboration with I Love New York. During the tours, awareness of available product was strengthened with representatives from Australia, UK/Ireland, Canada and Germany. Efforts led to 25% of tour operator participants reporting that they are adding Westchester to itineraries.
- ✓ Planned and hosted Setting the Scene: Film Production in Westchester Film a film event to engage over 130 partners (in-market and film industry) in building a more film-friendly Westchester that took place at Hudson River Museum featuring guest location scout panelists.

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- ✓ Partnered with Great Point Studios for a Studio Sessions: An Evening with Kanan panel discussion with industry professionals as they discuss their experiences filming Power Book III: Raising Kanan at Hollywood on Hudson, Lionsgate at Great Point Studios.
- ✓ Produced Reel Ready Westchester a virtual event for small businesses and chambers aimed to help them be film friendly, gain insights on attracting film shoots, earning location fees, and providing products and services to productions. Created a new digital resource checklist as a resource for businesses.
- ✓ Developed digital marketing campaign targeting film industry professional which featured film locations and industry testimonials; results demonstrably exceeded expectations, with a click-through rate (CTR) 18% higher, driving significant traffic to the film website.

ON-GOING

- ✓ Publish and distribute copies of the Travel & Meeting Guide and online digital version, plus produce official tourism brochures and content.
- ✓ Produce and distribute monthly leisure and quarterly business newsletters that highlight and feature the latest tourism and film happenings, events and packages to raise awareness and interest.
- ✓ Partner with regional organizations for Hudson Valley Restaurant Week, twice annually in March and November; Westchester Wine & Food Festival, JazzFest, YoFi film festival, Winter Wonderland, Revolutionary Westchester, and other events.
- ✓ Maintain and update Westchester Tourism & Film and Hudson Valley Tourism and I LOVE NY websites.
- ✓ Enhance the film section of the website with new blogs, resources and location images for film scouts, location managers and producers. Produce industry event vignettes to increase visibility for Westchester as a premiere stage for filming.
- ✓ Promote film and media productions, facilitate location scout inquiries, permit County-operated properties and provide assistance and support/solutions to production companies and municipalities.
- ✓ Promote hotel incentives and packages and tourism events on seasonal basis to tourists.

- ✓ Provide tourism partners with meeting and travel leads and inquiries received from trade shows and direct contact.

SERVICE INDICATORS:

	2023 Actual	2024 Estimated	2025 Planned
Tourism-generated impact on Westchester's economy	\$2 billion	\$2.2 billion	\$2.2 billion est.
Room occupancy tax revenue	\$7,065,053	\$6,889,200	\$8,503,000
Distribute Promotional Publications	10,000	101,000	62,000
Trade shows; meeting planner and media trips	17	22	20
Tracked Inquiries	20,000	62,342	62,000
Website Page Views	718,040	755,000	785,000
Westchester County Tourism Facebook: 20,079k Followers+			
Westchester County Tourism Twitter/X: 7,845 Followers+			
Westchester County Tourism Instagram: 22,586k Followers+			
Westchester County Tourism YouTube: 216 subscribers; 4 million watch hours			
Westchester County Film Facebook: 1,300 followers +			
Westchester County Film Instagram: 650 Followers			
Westchester County Tourism Film Sessions: 16,500			
Westchester County Consumer Newsletter: 42,000			
Westchester County Meeting Planner B2B Newsletter: 2,484			
Westchester County Film Newsletter: 1,404			

County Executive (11)
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Objects of Expenditure		Expended 2023	Adopted 2024	Appropriated 2024	Projected 2024	Requested 2025	Allowed 2025
Personal Service:							
Annual-Regular:	GROUP						
Director of Tourism	XVIII	1	1	1	1	1	1
Deputy Director of Tourism	XIV	1	1	1	1	1	1
Program Admin (Tourism)	XII		1	1	1	1	1
Program Specialist (Tourism)	X	1	1	1	1	1	1
Administrative Asst.	X	1	1	1	1	1	1
Total Positions		4	5	5	5	5	5

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Account Class	Account Rollup Name	Expended 2023	Adopted 2024	Appropriated 2024	Projected 2024	Requested 2025	Allowed 2025
100 Annual Regular Salaries	1010 Net-Annual Regular	538,510	588,331	588,331	588,331	604,135	604,135
		538,510	588,331	588,331	588,331	604,135	604,135
101 Other Personal Services	1200 Hourly	0	3,000	3,000	3,000	0	0
		0	3,000	3,000	3,000	0	0
300 Material & Supplies	3070 Book and Periodicals	2,466	3,500	3,500	3,500	3,800	3,800
	3600 Printing & Office Suppl	2,546	2,000	2,000	2,000	2,000	2,000
	3700 Postage Costs	764	2,000	2,000	2,000	1,000	1,000
		5,776	7,500	7,500	7,500	6,800	6,800
400 Expenses	4070 Equip Service & Rental	32,213	45,500	45,500	45,500	45,500	45,500
	4100 Membership Fees	6,450	6,375	6,375	6,375	7,648	7,648
	4110 Travel and Meals	57,589	60,000	58,192	60,000	65,231	65,231
	4140 Communications	1,392	1,600	1,600	1,600	1,600	1,600
	4250 Public & Legal Notices	482,305	500,000	477,714	500,000	475,258	475,258
	4380 Contractual Services	95,064	125,000	152,500	125,000	260,141	260,141
	4912 Advance to Grants	49,947	52,000	53,808	52,000	54,000	54,000
	5125 Community Services	626,492	2,124,923	2,124,923	2,124,923	1,026,920	1,026,920
		1,351,452	2,915,398	2,920,612	2,915,398	1,936,298	1,936,298
599 Inter-Departmental Charge	5205 Information Support Svc	3,105	4,536	4,536	4,536	5,701	5,701
		3,105	4,536	4,536	4,536	5,701	5,701
Total Expenditures		1,898,842	3,518,765	3,523,979	3,518,765	2,552,934	2,552,934
Net Expenditures		1,898,842	3,518,765	3,523,979	3,518,765	2,552,934	2,552,934